



Prepared with Synoptic

Preliminary investigation report

Haul truck and light vehicle collision, Bindarra Gold Mine

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Summary

At 02:47 on 12/08/2026, an empty 220 t class haul truck was descending the main ramp of the Stage 4 open pit at Bindarra Gold Mine when it collided with a light vehicle coming out of the RL 312 dewatering spur. The driver of the light vehicle, a grade control technician employed by a survey subcontractor, was seriously injured. He suffered a fractured left clavicle, three fractured left ribs and a small pneumothorax (air in the chest cavity). The light vehicle was destroyed, and the truck was damaged. The pit stood down for 9 hours 15 minutes, while the ramp below RL 340 stayed closed for 22 hours. The investigation has made no findings. It is examining how the spur was opened, the controls at the intersection, the collision awareness system and contractor access to the pit. In the meantime, the spur remains closed, and a site-wide direction requires a radio call before any vehicle enters a Stage 4 pit intersection.

What we know

At 02:47:12 local time on 12/08/2026, HT-407, a 220 t class rigid haul truck descending empty after the crib (meal) break, collided with light vehicle LV-118 at the RL 312 dewatering spur intersection on the main ramp of the Stage 4 open pit at Bindarra Gold Mine. LV-118's only occupant was a grade control technician employed by a survey subcontractor, on his third night shift at the mine.

The 240 m spur, cut under works order WO-26-4471 to reach dewatering bore DW-14, opened to light vehicles on 02/08/2026. Its construction sign was removed that day and not replaced. The intersection is absent from the site traffic management plan and from the FMS in-cab map, last published on 24/07/2026.

At about 22:10 on 04/08/2026, a dewatering technician came out of the spur in front of a descending haul truck, then reversed and let it pass. He reported it that night. The report was closed on 06/08/2026 after the crew were reminded to take care, and was not referred outside the dewatering department. LV-118's driver received his site access card on 09/08/2026. There is no evidence that he completed the site supplement or the light vehicle pit driving assessment.

LV-118 left the bore collar at about 02:45. At 02:47:06 HT-407 was at 37 km/h, 53 m above the spur mouth, where survey shows LV-118's beacon first comes into view over the crest. The operator estimated the distance at about 40 m. Brake pressure rose 1.4 seconds later, with full retard and 14 degrees of right steering. At 02:47:09 the collision awareness system logged LV-118 at 21.4 m, but the alert was suppressed inside the S4-LOAD geofence (a mapped area where alerts are switched off) and nothing appeared in the cab. Neither driver made a radio call before the intersection. In an account not yet finalised, LV-118's driver said he slowed at the mouth but did not believe he stopped.

HT-407's front left struck LV-118's right side at 24 km/h, pushing it 18.4 m down the ramp and onto its left side against the inner windrow (earth bund).

Dispatch stopped all Stage 4 traffic at 02:48:01 and paged the emergency response team, which arrived at 02:54. A second responder brought the hydraulic rescue tool at 03:07. The driver, conscious throughout, was extricated at 03:14 and flown to the metropolitan trauma centre at 07:40 with a fractured left clavicle, three fractured left ribs and a small pneumothorax (air in the chest cavity). LV-118 was destroyed, but its roll-over protection structure was not breached. HT-407 returned to service on 14/08/2026. The pit stood down for 9 hours 15 minutes and the ramp below RL 340 was closed for 22 hours.

What we are looking at

- 1. How the spur was opened.** The investigation is examining how works order WO-26-4471 classified the spur as routine earthworks. That classification placed it outside management of change procedure ORR-PRO-022, which is how a new road reaches the traffic management plan's owner, the survey department and the contractor's technical services group. Eleven of the fourteen new Stage 4 roads cut since the last plan review were opened the same way.
- 2. Controls at the intersection.** The investigation is examining how intersections are added to the plan's nine positive call points (a radio call before entering). It is also examining why the RL 312 intersection had no warning sign and no stop or give-way control. A survey gives 41 m of sight distance, against a stopping distance of 96 m for an empty haul truck. The closure of hazard reports about this kind of interaction is also being examined, including HAZ-2026-0917 about this spur. So is the discretion that Mines Safety Guideline MSG-14 leaves to sites, which is examined for its shape, not for any failing by the Inspectorate.
- 3. The collision awareness system.** The investigation is examining the extension of the S4-LOAD geofence up the main ramp on 09/06/2026. It is also looking at who was told and what operators understood the system was doing there.
- 4. Contractor access to the pit.** Site access cards are issued without a check of the pit driving assessment, and the investigation is examining how that happens. It is seeking the contractor's records on whether the driver was given the site supplement.
- 5. Wider site arrangements.** Two arrangements are being examined as site-wide risks. The first is a haul roster of fourteen consecutive 12 hour 30 minute night shifts. The second is night shift extrication, which relies on a second responder called from the village 11 km away. Emergency response rosters for the site's other three night shifts are being obtained.
- 6. Matters that could not be resolved.** The investigation could not resolve whether airborne dust on the ramp delayed the truck operator's first sight of the light vehicle. Whether the truck operator was fatigued on the approach also remains open.

Containment and next steps

The interim actions below are not evidence of what led to the collision.

- The RL 312 spur was barricaded on the night of the occurrence, and it remains closed to all traffic.
- At 05:10 on 12/08/2026 the Mining Manager issued a site-wide direction. It requires a positive call on the pit channel before entering any Stage 4 pit intersection, whether or not that intersection is listed in the traffic management plan. The direction was read at the next four pre-starts and posted beside the Appendix B board in the Stage 4 crib room. It stands until BIN-TMP-004 is amended.
- On 14/08/2026 survey measured sight distance at the other ten unlisted roads cut in Stage 4 since the last plan review. Two of them fell below the plan's minimum, and both are closed until a stop control is installed.
- On 28/08/2026 the contractor's technical services group added suppressed proximity events to its monthly collision awareness report. The group is also re-cutting the previous twelve months for the Stage 4 fleet. The first report was due on 30/09/2026.

Several lines of inquiry remain open. The investigation is still obtaining the contractor's records on whether the light vehicle driver received the site supplement, and it is also obtaining the emergency response rosters for the other three night shifts. A second conversation with that driver is pending, so his account is not finalised. No other haul truck operator has yet been asked what he understood the collision awareness system to be doing on the ramp. Airborne dust also remains open. Finally, the draft report has not yet gone outside the investigation for factual correction. [NOT ESTABLISHED: expected timing of the remaining steps and of the final report]

Distribution

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